



Momentum 360

Photo, Video, Digital Marketing Services

2026 EDITION

AEO

GEO

AI
SEARCH

BEYOND SEO

The AI Search Playbook.

How small businesses get **found, trusted, and chosen** as search becomes answer-driven and agent-assisted.

A Momentum 360 thought-leadership guide to AEO & GEO, turning real-world proof into search-ready digital assets for the era of AI Overviews, AI Mode, and answer engines.

2.5B

people see Google AI Overviews every month

900M

weekly ChatGPT users searching for answers

+40%

visibility lift from proven GEO tactics

Momentum 360

Photo, Video & Digital Marketing Services · Philadelphia & nationwide

Strategic guide · 2026 Edition
momentumvirtualtours.com

Built for the businesses that can't afford to wait.

Search is changing faster than at any point since Google launched. This guide exists to turn that change into an advantage for owner-operated and local businesses, before competitors learn how AI search works.

What's inside

A complete, plain-English playbook: how search evolved into answers, the data behind the shift, the three layers of modern visibility (SEO, AEO, GEO), a six-layer visibility stack, schema and crawler controls, the new metrics that matter, and a 30-day action plan you can run next week.

Who it's for

Small-business owners, marketers, real-estate professionals, and local-service operators who want practical execution, not theoretical AI hype.

How to read it

Each chapter ends with **Key Takeaways** or a **Checklist**. Look for the gold Momentum Edge panels, they show where our visual, local, and search work directly produces the proof AI engines reward.



THE MOMENTUM EDGE

We don't just write about AI search. Every virtual tour, photo shoot, review, and service page we produce becomes a structured, citable proof asset, exactly the raw material AI systems retrieve and recommend.

Data in this guide was compiled in June 2026 from public industry research and primary platform documentation; see References (pages 27 and 28). Figures from third-party studies are attributed to their sources. Google and other third-party marks appear only as small nominative/educational references and imply no affiliation or endorsement.

What you'll learn

PART I • THE SHIFT

01	The New Search Reality Why "Are we ranking?" became the wrong question	04
02	How Search Evolved From keywords to answers to agents	06
03	The 2026 State of AI Search The data behind the shift	07
04	Why This Matters Now The conversion risk and the opportunity	08

PART II • THE FRAMEWORK

05	SEO, AEO & GEO in Plain English Three layers of one visibility system	10
06	The AI Search Visibility Stack The six signals that win together	11

PART III • THE PLAYBOOK

07	Layer 1 • Build the SEO Foundation Still the engine room	13
08	Layer 2 • Become Answer-Ready (AEO) Answer the questions buyers actually ask	14
09	Layer 3 • Prepare for Generative Engines (GEO) Clarity, proof & the off-site game	15
10	Structured Data & Schema Speak the language machines read	17
11	Local Search Still Drives Action Maps, profiles, and real-world intent	18
12	Trust Signals AI Can Read Reputation becomes infrastructure	19
13	Visual Proof Is a Search Asset Why Momentum 360 is built for this moment	20
14	Crawler Controls & AI Readiness Be intentional about access	21

PART IV • EXECUTION

15	Measure Visibility Beyond Clicks New KPIs for AI search	23
16	The 30-Day AI Search Action Plan From thought leadership to execution	24
17	AI Search Readiness Scorecard Score yourself, find the gaps	25
18	Why Momentum 360 Proof, partnership, and next steps	26
19	References & Asset Notes Source-backed research	27

EXECUTIVE THESIS · 01

The New Search Reality

Search is moving from lists of links toward generated answers, follow-up conversations, local recommendations, and AI agents that help people take action. That does not make SEO irrelevant, it makes the old job too small.

Businesses still need crawlable websites, useful content, clean local data, strong reputation signals, and media that proves they are real. What changed is that those signals now have to be effortless for **both people and AI systems** to understand, retrieve, and trust.

When a buyer asks an AI assistant "who should I trust for this service near me?", the system doesn't return ten blue links. It synthesizes an answer from the sources it understands best, and recommends a short list. The

business that is clearest, most consistent, and most provable wins the recommendation.

For small businesses and local organizations, the opportunity is practical and time-sensitive: become the clearest, most trusted, most useful source in your category **before competitors learn how AI search works.**

That is the entire thesis of this guide. The rest is execution.

The business question changed from "Are we ranking?" to "Are we the source AI search can confidently surface when a buyer is ready to act?"

◆ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ◆ SEO is the foundation. AEO and GEO are the expansion, not replacements.
- ◆ Visibility is no longer just rank. It includes answers, citations, maps, snippets, recommendations, and assisted bookings.
- ◆ Momentum 360's advantage is turning real business proof (tours, photos, reviews, results) into search-ready digital assets.

References: [1] Google Search Central · [2] AI features and your website · [3] Google: A new era for AI Search · [13] Momentum 360



PART ONE

The Shift.

Search didn't get an upgrade. It changed jobs. Here is how we got from keywords to answers, what the 2026 data actually shows, and why the change rewrites the economics of visibility.

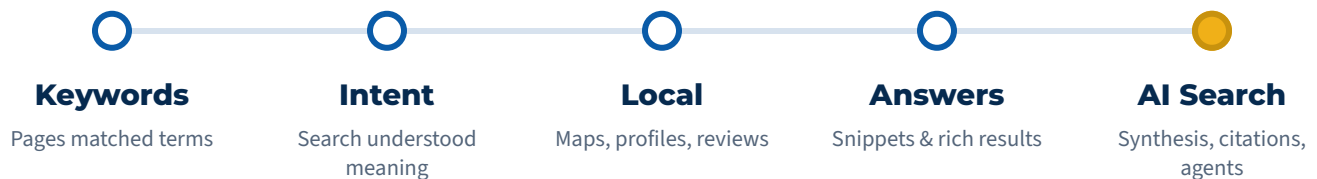
- | | How Search Evolved
- | | The 2026 Data
- | | The Conversion Risk



FROM KEYWORDS TO ANSWERS • 02

How Search Evolved

Search used to reward matching pages to keywords. Then it matured into semantic relevance, intent, quality, local context, and entity understanding. AI-powered search is the next stage, and it behaves differently.



Instead of only ranking pages, modern systems **retrieve** information, **synthesize** an answer, **cite or link** sources, and invite follow-up questions. Google describes the core techniques openly: retrieval-augmented generation, and query fan-out, where one user question silently triggers many related searches behind the scenes.

The practical implication is simple but demanding. A business must now be understandable across its **whole footprint**: website, Google Business Profile, service pages, reviews, photos, videos, structured data, directories, and third-party proof. A gap anywhere is a gap the AI fills with a competitor.

One question becomes many. Query fan-out means your business is being evaluated on dozens of sub-questions you never see.

Based on Google Search Central guidance on AI features and generative search [1][2]

References: [1] Google Search Central · [2] AI features and your website

THE DATA BEHIND THE SHIFT · 03

The 2026 State of AI Search

This is not a forecast anymore. It's a measurable change in how billions of people find answers. A snapshot of where things stand as of mid-2026.

~900M

Weekly active ChatGPT users

OpenAI / DemandSage, Feb 2026, roughly double a year earlier

2.5B

Monthly users seeing Google AI Overviews

Google earnings / Digiday, 2025

1B+

Monthly AI Mode users, one year after launch

Google I/O 2026

15%→8%

Click-through on a link when an AI summary appears

Pew Research Center, July 2025

-34.5%

Lower CTR for the top result when an AI Overview shows

Ahrefs, 2025 (rising through year-end)

-25%

Projected drop in traditional search volume by 2026

Gartner forecast, Feb 2024

What the numbers say in one sentence

Impressions are rising while clicks compress. BrightEdge measured Google impressions up roughly **49% year-over-year** even as click-through fell about **30%**. More people are seeing answers; fewer are clicking ten links to find them. Visibility is increasingly won inside the answer.

♦ WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOU

- ♦ Being invisible to AI answer engines now carries the same cost being invisible on page one did a decade ago.
- ♦ "Impressions up, clicks down" is the new normal: measure influence, not just traffic.
- ♦ The window to become a category's default answer is open now and closing as competitors adapt.

References: [3][5] adoption · [9] Gartner · [10] Pew Research · [11] Semrush · [12] BrightEdge · [21] Ahrefs. Figures attributed to original studies; methodologies differ, see References.

THE CONVERSION RISK · 04

Why This Matters Now

AI search changes the business impact of visibility. A customer may compare providers, check reputation, ask follow-up questions, and decide to book, all before ever browsing your website.

Industry and research signals point the same way: search behavior is shifting toward answer engines, AI summaries reduce traditional clicking, and impressions can rise even while click-through rates fall. The risk isn't that you stop ranking. It's that you rank, get summarized, and never get the click, while the AI recommends whoever it understood and trusted most.

1

Less predictable clicks

Winning visibility may no longer mean the same traffic pattern. The answer can satisfy the buyer before a single visit.

2

More weight on trust

Reviews, proof, expertise, and accurate data carry more influence in what AI chooses to surface and recommend.

3

Higher-value conversions

Calls, bookings, forms, and local actions matter more than vanity traffic. Fewer, warmer, better-qualified buyers.

**THE MOMENTUM EDGE**

When the buyer's decision moves upstream into the answer, your proof has to be there too. That's why we attach tours, photos, reviews, and clear service data to the exact pages and profiles where AI forms its recommendation, so the influence happens whether or not the click does.

References: [9] Gartner · [10] Pew · [11] Semrush · [12] BrightEdge



PART TWO

The Framework.

SEO, AEO, and GEO aren't three competing programs. They're three layers of one visibility system, and they sit on top of a stack of signals that only win when they work together.

|| SEO · AEO · GEO

|| The Visibility Stack



DEFINITIONS THAT MATTER · 05

SEO, AEO & GEO in Plain English

These are not three disconnected acronyms competing for budget. They are three layers of the same visibility system, and Google itself says AEO and GEO, for Google Search, still sit inside SEO.

Layer	Plain-English meaning	Primary goal
SEO	Make your business discoverable in search engines.	Rank, earn clicks, and build a durable foundation.
AEO	Make your content answer-ready.	Be selected, summarized, or cited when people ask direct questions.
GEO	Make your business understandable to generative engines.	Show up in synthesized AI answers and recommendations.

SEO: the foundation

Crawlable, fast, well-structured pages with clear topics and clean technical health. Nothing downstream works without it.

AEO: the answer layer

Content shaped around real buyer questions, with the answer stated first, in the language people actually use.

GEO: the synthesis layer

Clear entities, consistent descriptions, and provable expertise so generative engines can understand, summarize, and cite you accurately. The original GEO research (Aggarwal et al., KDD 2024) found that simply **citing sources, adding statistics, and including quotations can lift a source's visibility in generative answers by up to ~40%.**

◆ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ◆ Google says AEO/GEO are common labels, but for Google Search they still live inside SEO.
- ◆ The strongest approach isn't chasing hacks: it's building content and proof that deserve to be used.
- ◆ Research shows the highest-leverage GEO moves are also the most honest ones: cite, quantify, and quote real sources.

References: [1] Google Search Central · [8] Aggarwal et al., GEO (KDD 2024)

MOMENTUM 360 FRAMEWORK · 06

The AI Search Visibility Stack

The winning strategy is not one tactic: it's a stack of signals that reinforce each other. Read it bottom-up: each layer makes the one above it more credible to people and machines alike.

LAYER 6 Conversion Path	Calls, booking links, forms, lead routing, and follow-up that turn visibility into revenue.
LAYER 5 Measurement	Search Console AI reports, rankings, calls, leads, content performance, and AI-visibility checks.
LAYER 4 Trust Proof	Reviews, testimonials, case studies, credentials, policies, and third-party mentions.
LAYER 3 Rich Media	Photos, video, virtual tours, project galleries, metadata, and local visual proof.
LAYER 2 Answer Content	FAQs, service explainers, comparison pages, buyer questions, and location pages.
LAYER 1 SEO Foundation	Crawlability, page structure, indexing, internal links, speed, schema, and Google Business Profile.



THE MOMENTUM EDGE

Momentum 360 works across this entire stack by design: local SEO and Google Business Profile optimization, visual content and virtual tours, web development, paid media, reporting, and lead conversion. Most agencies own one or two layers. The advantage is owning the whole column so the signals actually reinforce each other.

References: [1] Google Search Central · [4] Search Console AI reports · [13][14] Momentum 360



PART THREE

The Playbook.

Eight chapters of execution: the foundation, answer-ready content, generative-engine readiness, schema, local search, trust, visual proof, and crawler controls. This is the work.

- | | Foundation
- | | AEO
- | | GEO
- | | Schema
- | | Local
- | | Trust
- | | Visual Proof
- | | Crawlers

STILL THE ENGINE ROOM • 07

Layer 1 • Build the SEO Foundation

AI search still depends on discoverable, crawlable, indexable content. If a website is unclear, slow, thin, duplicated, or hard to crawl, AI-powered search has less reliable material to retrieve, and reaches for a competitor instead.

A strong foundation starts with clean service pages, location relevance, sensible internal links, accurate metadata, clear headings, structured data where useful, mobile performance, and Search Console visibility.

For local organizations, that foundation also includes consistent name, address, phone, hours, categories, and services, plus review signals, across every important platform. Inconsistency is the single most common, most fixable reason AI gets a business wrong.

Foundation checklist

- ☒ Search engines can crawl and index every key service page.
- ☒ Each page clearly states who you serve, where, and what outcome you deliver.
- ☒ Location pages and Google Business Profile details are identical and current.
- ☒ Visual assets are named, titled, and placed where they support buying decisions.
- ☒ Core Web Vitals and mobile performance are healthy; nothing important is buried behind slow loads.

References: [1] Google Search Central · [2] AI features and your website · [14] Momentum 360 AI SEO

AEO WITHOUT GIMMICKS · 08

Layer 2 • Become Answer-Ready

Answer Engine Optimization is about giving buyers direct, trustworthy answers in the language they actually use, and structuring those answers so a machine can lift them cleanly into a response.

Small businesses lose AI-search visibility when their websites never answer the questions customers ask before buying: pricing ranges, timelines, service area, qualifications, process, guarantees, comparisons, and what happens after a form is submitted. An answer-ready content library turns those questions into useful pages and sections, written like a capable expert explaining the decision, not a keyword page trying to manipulate a result.

Q**Question hubs**

Group related buyer questions by service, location, and decision stage so the topic reads as authoritative.

A**Answer-first**

Lead each section with the direct answer, then add nuance and proof. Machines lift the first clear sentence.

VS**Comparison content**

Help buyers choose between options without hiding tradeoffs. Honest comparisons get cited.

Write the way your customer asks the question, then answer it in the first sentence. That single habit is most of AEO.

References: [1] Google Search Central · [2] AI features and your website

GEO AS CLARITY PLUS PROOF · 09

Layer 3 · Prepare for Generative Engines

Generative Engine Optimization focuses on whether AI systems can understand, summarize, and cite your business accurately. The peer-reviewed GEO research formalized the challenge, and, helpfully, the highest-impact moves are also the most legitimate.

Generative engines synthesize answers from many sources at once, which creates a new visibility problem: you're competing to be understood and trusted, not just to rank. In practice, GEO favors clear entities, consistent descriptions, original expertise, real proof, structured service information, and content that adds value beyond commodity summaries.

+40%

Visibility lift in generative answers from citing sources, adding statistics, and quoting authorities

Aggarwal et al., GEO, KDD 2024

The three moves the research actually validated

The GEO study tested nine tactics. Three stood out, and none of them are tricks. They simply make content more trustworthy:

“”

Add quotations

The single strongest lever. Quote credible experts, customers, or primary sources directly.

123

Add statistics

Specific, sourced numbers make a passage more citable than vague claims.

§

Cite sources

Attribute facts to authorities. Citations signal reliability to the engine.

Notably, the same research found keyword stuffing did not help, and sometimes hurt. The honest tactics win.

◆ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ◆ Define the business clearly and consistently across the entire web, one identity, everywhere.
- ◆ Publish proof AI can reference: case studies, photos, videos, reviews, project pages, and process pages.
- ◆ Quote, quantify, and cite. Avoid shallow AI-only content: expert-led, sourced material is far more citable.

References: [1] Google Search Central · [8] Aggarwal et al., GEO · [14] Momentum 360 AI SEO

GEO • THE OFF-SITE GAME • 09

Get Mentioned, Not Just Linked

Here's the finding reshaping how off-site strategy works in the AI era: **brand mentions now appear to matter more than backlinks**. What people say about you across the web (even without a link) is becoming the strongest signal of whether AI engines surface you.

A 2025 Ahrefs analysis of ~75,000 brands found that branded web mentions correlated with appearing in Google AI Overviews far more strongly than total backlinks did, roughly a 3-to-1 difference. The takeaway for a small business isn't "stop earning links." It's "start earning conversations."

Generative engines also lean heavily on a handful of high-trust community and reference sources (Reddit, YouTube, Wikipedia, LinkedIn, Quora, and reputable "best of" lists) when they assemble recommendations. Being present and well-regarded in those places puts you in the citation pool.

3:1

Branded mentions vs. backlinks as a correlate of AI Overview presence

Ahrefs, 2025 (single-engine correlation)

~1.2%

Of local businesses currently get recommended by AI, the field is wide open

Industry analysis, 2025 to 2026

The highest-leverage off-site moves for local businesses

- ☒ Earn placement on current-year "best [service] in [city]" listicles, among the most-cited formats in AI answers.
- ☒ Build genuine presence and reviews on third-party platforms AI cross-references (Google, Yelp, industry directories).
- ☒ Get named in local press, roundups, and relevant community threads, unlinked mentions still count.
- ☒ Link your sameAs profiles (LinkedIn, socials, Wikidata where applicable) so the engine merges every reference into one confident entity.



THE MOMENTUM EDGE

Earning mentions takes real proof worth talking about. Momentum 360's tours, photography, and case-study assets give press, partners, and customers something concrete to reference, turning your work into the kind of off-site signal AI engines reward.

References: [8] GEO research • [26] Ahrefs brand-mention study • [27] AI citation-source studies

SPEAK THE LANGUAGE MACHINES READ · 10

Structured Data & Schema

Structured data is how you hand an AI system the facts about your business in a format it cannot misread. It doesn't guarantee a citation, but it removes ambiguity, and ambiguity is what loses you the recommendation.

An important clarification first: Google states there is **no special schema required to appear in AI Overviews or AI Mode**. So why bother? Because well-formed schema still earns rich results and, more importantly for AI, disambiguates your entity: it tells every engine, in plain machine-readable terms, exactly who you are and what you offer. A handful of types carry most of the weight.

Schema type	What it clarifies	Note
LocalBusiness	Name, address, phone, hours, geo, price range	Use the most specific subtype (e.g. Plumber)
Organization	Brand identity, logo, and sameAs profile links	The entity anchor, one stable @id site-wide
Service	Each service, area served, and provider	Reference the Organization @id
FAQPage	Direct question-and-answer pairs	Lost rich snippets, but still parsed, keep it
Review / Rating	Proof on Products, Events, Courses, etc.	Can't self-rate your own business for stars
BreadcrumbList	Site structure and page relationships	Match the visible trail

The #1 local schema mistake: marking up your own reviews on your LocalBusiness page to earn star ratings. Google has treated that as self-serving and ineligible since 2019. Collect reviews on Google and third-party platforms instead.

What Google says you don't need: AI-specific text files, content "chunking," llms.txt, or special AI schema. As Google's John Mueller put it, llms.txt is "comparable to the keywords meta tag", i.e., not used.



THE MOMENTUM EDGE

We pair structured data with structured proof. A correctly marked-up Service page backed by a virtual tour, real photos, and third-party reviews gives AI engines a complete, verifiable entity, the kind they reach for first.

References: [1] Google Search Central · [22] Schema.org · [28] Google on llms.txt · [14] Momentum 360 AI SEO

MAPS, PROFILES & REAL-WORLD INTENT • 11

Local Search Still Drives Action

For small businesses, the highest-value AI-search moments stay stubbornly local: "best contractor near me," "tour a venue before booking," "who can fix this today," "which provider has strong reviews in my area?"

Google specifically points to **Google Business Profiles** for local business visibility in generative AI responses. That makes profile completeness, categories, reviews, photos, services, and posts more important, not less. Survey data backs the behavior shift, too: roughly **1 in 4 consumers** reported using an AI tool to find a local business in a recent week, a share that climbs sharply among younger buyers.

Local visibility checklist

- ☒ Complete business categories, services, hours, and service areas, no blanks.
- ☒ Add fresh photos, tours, and videos that show the real experience.
- ☒ Respond to reviews, and turn repeat questions into published content.
- ☒ Align Google Business Profile posts and website pages around the same service language.
- ☒ Keep name, address, and phone identical across every directory and listing.



THE MOMENTUM EDGE

As a Google Trusted Photographer Agency, Momentum 360's local work connects straight to this shift: Google Business Profile optimization, listings management, reviews, Google Street View, photography, and virtual tours all build the evidence layer a local buyer (and an AI) needs to choose you.

References: [1] Google Search Central · [13][14][15] Momentum 360 · [23] AI local-search consumer data

REPUTATION BECOMES INFRASTRUCTURE · 12

Trust Signals AI Can Read

AI search doesn't replace trust. It compresses trust evaluation into fewer moments. A business with clear reviews, visible proof, complete policies, and recognizable third-party validation simply gives AI systems and buyers more evidence to work with.

Trust should be visible exactly where decisions happen: near pricing explanations, booking forms, service descriptions, location pages, and conversion calls-to-action, not quarantined on an "About" page nobody reads.



Reviews

Quantity matters, but recency, specificity, and your response behavior matter just as much.



Case studies

Show the starting problem, the work performed, and the measurable outcome.



Credentials

Make licenses, partnerships, awards, and platform expertise easy to verify at a glance.



Policies

Reduce buyer anxiety with clear timelines, ownership, cancellation, and support details.

References: [1] Google Search Central · [13] Momentum 360 · [16] Matterport case study

WHY MOMENTUM 360 IS BUILT FOR THIS MOMENT • 13

Visual Proof Is a Search Asset

AI search is not only text. Google explicitly notes that high-quality images and video create additional opportunities for visibility in generative AI search experiences. That's where Momentum 360's original strength becomes a strategic advantage.

Virtual tours, photography, video, drone work, 3D renderings, project galleries, and Google Street View aren't just creative assets. They're **proof assets**. For small businesses, visual proof answers questions a paragraph can't: What does the space look like? Is this business real? Can I trust the team? What will the experience feel like before I visit, call, or book?

The market data is blunt about the payoff. Listings and properties with immersive 3D tours consistently outperform. Matterport reports properties can earn meaningfully more qualified leads and hold visitor attention several times longer than static listings. In an answer-driven world, that engagement is also a trust signal AI can read.

49%

More qualified leads for listings with a 3D tour

Matterport

3 to 6×

Longer time spent on listings with immersive 3D

Matterport

500+

Projects delivered by Momentum 360 across 50 states

Momentum 360

◆ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ◆ Use media to reduce buyer uncertainty at the exact moment of decision.
- ◆ Attach media to the right pages, profiles, and local listings, not a hidden gallery.
- ◆ Treat every shoot as a search, reputation, and conversion asset simultaneously.

References: [1] Google Search Central • [13][15] Momentum 360 • [16] Matterport case study

BE INTENTIONAL ABOUT ACCESS · 14

Crawler Controls & AI Readiness

AI-search visibility is partly a technical access decision. You should know which bots can reach your content, and what tradeoff you're making when you allow or block each one.

The key distinction is **search inclusion vs. model training**. OpenAI separates OAI-SearchBot (surfaces you in ChatGPT answers) from GPTBot (model training) and ChatGPT-User (live user fetches). Anthropic splits Claude-SearchBot from ClaudeBot the same way. One nuance trips up many sites: Google's Google-Extended token opts you out of Gemini training and grounding, but it does **not** remove you from AI Overviews or AI Mode, which ride the normal Googlebot index. Block the wrong token and you quietly disappear from the answers you want to win.

Crawler	Purpose	Typical stance
Googlebot	Search index + AI Overviews/AI Mode	Allow
Google-Extended	Gemini training/grounding only	Your choice
OAI-SearchBot	ChatGPT search citations	Allow
GPTBot / ClaudeBot	OpenAI / Anthropic model training	Your choice
Claude-SearchBot	Anthropic search indexing	Allow
PerplexityBot	Perplexity answer engine	Allow

The load-bearing control is nosnippet. To stay in Search but keep a page out of AI summaries, that's the directive (with max-snippet / data-nosnippet for finer control), not Google-Extended, and not llms.txt.

AI-readiness checklist

- ☒ Review robots.txt and noindex directives, confirm they're intentional, not accidental.
- ☒ Allow search and search-citation crawlers on public conversion and content pages.
- ☒ Decide training-vs-search separately: you can allow citations while opting out of training.
- ☒ Keep private, thin, duplicate, or outdated material out of the index.

References: [2] Google Search Central · [6] OpenAI crawler docs · [29] Anthropic crawler docs



IV

PART FOUR

Execution.

Measurement that matches the new reality, a 30-day plan you can start Monday, a scorecard to find your gaps, and a partner built to run it with you.

| | New KPIs | | 30-Day Plan | | Scorecard

| | Why Momentum 360



NEW KPIS FOR AI SEARCH · 15

Measure Visibility Beyond Clicks

Traditional reporting over-weighted rankings and sessions. Those still matter, but AI search demands a broader scorecard that connects discovery, trust, and conversion.

In June 2026, Google launched dedicated **Search Generative AI performance reports** in Search Console, the first standalone view of how often your pages appear inside AI Overviews and AI Mode. (Today it shows impressions only, with a phased rollout, but it confirms the direction of travel.) Google Analytics also added a native **"AI Assistant" channel** in 2026, so referrals from ChatGPT, Gemini, and Claude finally show up as their own source. Connect both to the outcomes that pay the bills: calls, bookings, form fills, qualified leads, and revenue.

Old KPI	AI-era companion KPI	Why it matters
Rankings	AI Share of Voice	How often you're mentioned vs. competitors is the new #1.
Sessions	Qualified actions	Traffic only matters if it produces calls, bookings, and leads.
Keyword volume	Question demand	AI search begins with buyer questions and follow-ups.
Page views	Assisted conversion	AI visibility can influence buyers before they ever visit.
Traffic source	AI referral share	ChatGPT/Perplexity/Gemini referrals are a new, trackable channel.

And here's the encouraging part: AI referrals are low in volume but unusually high in intent. Similarweb's 2025 data put the conversion rate of AI-referred visitors at roughly **double** that of traditional organic traffic, fewer clicks, but warmer, more decision-ready buyers.



THE MOMENTUM EDGE

Momentum 360 already speaks this language through reporting tied to real business numbers, rank movement, lead volume, and revenue, not vanity metrics. The healthiest dashboard connects discovery, trust, and conversion in one view.

References: [4] Search Console AI reports · [10] Pew · [12] BrightEdge · [30] Similarweb AI referral conversion · [14] Momentum 360

FROM THOUGHT LEADERSHIP TO EXECUTION • 16

The 30-Day AI Search Action Plan

The businesses that win AI search won't wait for a perfect playbook. They'll build a focused operating rhythm (audit, fix, publish, measure) in weekly cycles.

WEEK 1**Days 1 to 7**

Audit. Crawlability, Google Business Profile, service pages, reviews, key local listings, and conversion paths. Find what AI sees today.

WEEK 2**Days 8 to 14**

Fix the foundation. Refresh business descriptions, add missing services, clean location signals, repair technical blockers, and align NAP everywhere.

WEEK 3**Days 15 to 21**

Build the answer library. Top FAQs, process pages, comparison pages, and pricing explainers, answer-first, with schema applied.

WEEK 4**Days 22 to 30**

Prove & measure. Add visual proof, publish priority updates, launch measurement, and draft the next 60-day content plan.

◆ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ◆ Move in weekly cycles: audit, fix, publish, measure, then repeat.
- ◆ Start with the questions that block a buyer from contacting you.
- ◆ Use visual and local expertise to turn proof into search-ready assets, not one-off creative.

References: [1] Google Search Central · [4] Search Console AI reports · [14] Momentum 360 AI SEO

SELF-ASSESSMENT · 17

AI Search Readiness Scorecard

Score each item from 0 (not started) to 2 (fully in place). Total it honestly: the result tells you where to spend the next 30 days.

Core service pages are crawlable, clear, and current.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐
Google Business Profile has complete categories, services, hours, photos, and posts.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐
The website answers pricing, process, timing, location, and comparison questions.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐
Reviews and testimonials are recent, specific, and visible near conversion points.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐
Photos, videos, tours, and project galleries support the key buying decisions.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐
Structured data and metadata are implemented where useful.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐
Important pages have clear CTAs, fast contact paths, and lead tracking.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐
Search Console and conversion reporting are reviewed monthly.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐
Robots.txt and noindex rules are intentional, not accidental.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐
The team has a 30-day plan for content, proof, local updates, and measurement.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐

0 to 17

Visible gaps. Foundation and local data need work first, start with Week 1 of the plan.

18 to 25

On your way. Tighten answer content, proof, and measurement to pull ahead.

26 to 40

Strong. Now go deeper: richer content, stronger proof, sharper measurement.

References: [1][2][4] Google Search Central · [14] Momentum 360 AI SEO

FORWARD-THINKING BY OPERATING MODEL • 18

Why Momentum 360

Momentum 360 doesn't treat AEO and GEO as buzzwords. The existing service model already touches every signal AI search needs, which makes us a natural partner for businesses that need practical execution, not theoretical AI advice.

2015

Founded by a former Google team member

Momentum / Momentum 360

50

U.S. states served, across ~10 countries

Momentum 360

150+

Photographers & creators in the network

Momentum 360

Content creation

Photos, video, virtual tours, drone, 3D renderings, and case-study assets.

Search structure

SEO, AI SEO, Google Business Profile, listings, service pages, topic planning, and reporting.

Conversion design

Clear offers, booking paths, lead tracking, paid-media learning, and follow-up.

Credentials

Google Trusted Photographer Agency & Matterport Service Provider.

Book a Free AI Visibility Snapshot

We'll review how AI search currently sees your business (crawlability, Google Business Profile, answer content, proof, and conversion paths) and hand you a prioritized 30-day plan.

Get a free quote →



(215) 607-6482



info@momentumvirtualtours.com

momentumvirtualtours.com

References: [13][14][15] Momentum 360 • [16] Matterport case study

SOURCE-BACKED RESEARCH • 19

References

- 1 **Google Search Central: Optimizing your website for generative AI features.** Defines AEO/GEO labels, confirms SEO remains foundational for AI Overviews and AI Mode. developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/ai-optimization-guide
- 2 **Google Search Central: AI features and your website.** How site owners should approach inclusion in AI Overviews and AI Mode. developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/ai-features
- 3 **Google Blog: A new era for AI Search (I/O 2026).** AI Mode, Search agents, agentic booking, generative UI, Personal Intelligence. blog.google/products-and-platforms/products/search/search-io-2026/
- 4 **Google Search Central Blog: Generative AI performance reports in Search Console (2026).** Measuring AI-search performance. developers.google.com/search/blog/2026/06/gen-ai-performance-reports
- 5 **OpenAI: Introducing ChatGPT search.** Timely answers with linked web sources. openai.com/index/introducing-chatgpt-search/
- 6 **OpenAI Developers: Overview of OpenAI crawlers.** OAI-SearchBot, GPTBot, ChatGPT-User, and crawler controls. developers.openai.com/api/docs/bots
- 7 **Bing Search Blog: Introducing Bing generative search.** AI-generated layouts with links and sources. blogs.bing.com/search/July-2024/generative-search
- 8 **Aggarwal et al.: GEO: Generative Engine Optimization (KDD 2024).** Citing sources, statistics, and quotations can lift visibility up to ~40%. arxiv.org/abs/2311.09735
- 9 **Gartner: Search engine volume to drop 25% by 2026 (Feb 2024).** AI chatbots/virtual agents substitute for some traditional search. gartner.com/en/newsroom/press-releases/2024-02-19
- 10 **Pew Research Center: Users less likely to click links when an AI summary appears (Jul 2025).** Clicks fell from 15% to 8% with an AI summary present. pewresearch.org/short-reads/2025/07/22/
- 11 **Semrush: AI Overviews' impact on Search (2025).** AIO prevalence, zero-click behavior, and SERP composition. semrush.com/blog/semrush-ai-overviews-study/
- 12 **BrightEdge: One year into Google AI Overviews (2025).** Impressions up ~49% YoY; click-through down ~30%. brightedge.com/news/press-releases

SOURCES, LOGOS & USAGE NOTES • 19

References & Asset Notes

- 13 **Momentum 360: Main website.** Positioning, services, proof points, and consultation language. momentumvirtualtours.com
- 14 **Momentum 360: AI SEO Services.** AI-powered SEO positioning, reporting, and integration with visual/local assets. momentumvirtualtours.com/ai-search-engine-optimization/
- 15 **Momentum Digital: Momentum 360 property marketing.** Google Street View Trusted Agency positioning and property marketing scope. needmomentum.com/momentum-360/
- 16 **Matterport: Momentum 360 case study.** Services, Matterport, virtual staging, photography, and national client base. matterport.com/industries/case-studies/momentum-360-grows-its-business-30-locations-matterport
- 21 **Ahrefs: How AI Overviews reduce clicks (2025).** ~34.5% lower CTR for the top result when an AI Overview appears. ahrefs.com/blog/ai-overviews-reduce-clicks/
- 22 **Schema.org: Structured data vocabulary.** LocalBusiness, Organization, Service, FAQPage, Review, BreadcrumbList. schema.org
- 23 **AI & Local Search Consumer data (2025).** Roughly 1 in 4 consumers used AI to find a local business in a recent week. [Industry consumer survey, 2025](#)
- 24 **DemandSage / OpenAI: ChatGPT usage statistics (2026).** ~900M weekly active users as of early 2026. demandsage.com/chatgpt-statistics/
- 25 **Digiday: Google AI Overviews reach 2B+ monthly users (2025).** Adoption scale of AI Overviews. digiday.com
- 26 **Ahrefs: Brand mentions vs. AI Overview presence (2025).** Branded mentions correlated ~3× more strongly than total backlinks (single-engine correlation). ahrefs.com/blog/ai-overview-brand-correlation/
- 27 **AI citation-source studies (2025 to 2026).** Reddit, YouTube, Wikipedia, LinkedIn, and "best of" listicles among the most-cited sources across answer engines. [Semrush / Search Engine Land](#)
- 28 **Search Engine Journal: Google on llms.txt (2024).** John Mueller: llms.txt is "comparable to the keywords meta tag"; not used by major engines. searchenginejournal.com
- 29 **Anthropic: Crawler documentation.** ClaudeBot (training), Claude-SearchBot (search), Claude-User (user fetch); all honor robots.txt. support.anthropic.com
- 30 **Similarweb: AI referral conversion (2025).** AI-referred visitors converted at roughly double the rate of traditional organic traffic. similarweb.com

Asset & trademark notes

Momentum 360 logo and brand colors (blue #0857A8, gold #F0B018) were sampled from the official Momentum 360 logo asset. Third-party statistics are attributed to their original publishers; figures from secondary coverage should be confirmed against the primary source before external publication. Methodologies for AI-Overview prevalence and click-through impact differ between studies and are not directly comparable. Third-party names and marks (Google, OpenAI, Matterport, and others) appear only as small nominative/educational references and imply no affiliation, sponsorship, or endorsement.



Momentum 360

Photo, Video, Digital Marketing Services

Get found. Get trusted. **Get chosen.**

The era of AI search rewards the clearest, most provable business in every category. Let's make that yours.

(215) 607-6482 · momentumvirtualtours.com

Photo, Video & Digital Marketing Services · Philadelphia & nationwide · 2026 Edition